

Plumbot

Feature and functionality outline for Homebase Plumbers, focused on client benefit, revenue gain, and the full booking-to-review funnel.

Executive Summary

Plumbot is a WhatsApp-first sales, booking, and operations CRM for a plumbing business. It captures leads instantly, qualifies the customer, books site visits, reminds both customer and plumber, supports quotations, manages follow-ups, and keeps the team focused on high-value jobs.

The client benefit is simple: fewer missed enquiries, faster response times, better-qualified leads, stronger follow-up discipline, smoother job coordination, and more completed jobs turning into public social proof through Google reviews.

Core Value Proposition

Business Problem	Plumbot Functionality	Client Benefit / Potential Gain
Customers message outside office hours or during busy jobs.	Automatic WhatsApp intake and AI-guided responses.	More leads are captured before they drift to competitors. Potential gain: higher enquiry-to-booking conversion.
Staff spend time asking the same qualification questions.	Plumbot collects service type, area, plan status, budget, timeline, name, email, and preferred availability.	The team receives clearer job context before visiting. Potential gain: less admin time and more productive site visits.
Hot leads can get buried among casual enquiries.	Lead scoring classifies leads as cold, warm, hot, or very hot.	Sales attention goes to the best opportunities first. Potential gain: more closed jobs from the same lead volume.
Customers forget appointments or plumbers miss preparation details.	WhatsApp and email reminders, calendar scheduling, and plumber briefings.	Reduced no-shows and better punctuality. Potential gain: fewer wasted trips and smoother daily operations.
Completed jobs do not always create referrals or online trust.	New feature: job-completion email requesting a Google review.	More public reviews and stronger local credibility. Potential gain: better search trust, more organic leads, and stronger close rates.

Feature and Functionality Outline

1. WhatsApp Lead Capture and Conversation Automation

Feature	What It Does	Client Benefit / Potential Gain
Inbound WhatsApp webhook	Receives and processes customer messages in real time.	Immediate response improves trust and reduces missed enquiries.
AI-guided response flow	Handles greetings, service questions, pricing intent, qualification, booking nudges, and objections.	Customers get helpful answers without waiting for manual staff input.
English, Shona, and mixed-language support	Detects customer language and replies naturally in the same style.	Local customers feel understood, improving engagement and trust.
Duplicate event handling	Prevents repeated webhook messages from creating noisy duplicate replies.	Cleaner conversations and fewer awkward customer experiences.
Human handoff controls	The team can pause and resume the chatbot for individual leads.	Staff can step in for sensitive, high-value, or complex opportunities.

2. Qualification and Lead Intelligence

Feature	What It Does	Client Benefit / Potential Gain
Four-stage qualification framework	Moves customers through value, price, qualification, and close stages.	The sales conversation remains focused on booking a site visit or next action.
Project data extraction	Captures project type, area, property type, house stage, plan status, budget, timeline, and description.	Better job understanding before dispatch improves quote accuracy and professionalism.
Lead scoring	Scores and classifies leads as cold, warm, hot, or very hot.	The team prioritizes customers most likely to buy.
Priority lead notifications	Alerts the plumber/team when a very hot lead appears.	Fast human follow-up can secure revenue before a competitor responds.
Conversation history and summaries	Stores customer and bot messages with structured notes.	Team members can review context quickly without asking the customer to repeat themselves.

3. Booking, Availability, and Calendar

Feature	What It Does	Client Benefit / Potential Gain
Availability checking	Checks business hours, closed days, conflicts, minimum notice, and booking window.	Reduces scheduling mistakes and protects the plumber's calendar.
Date and time parsing	Understands customer availability and guides them toward valid booking options.	Customers can book naturally through chat instead of filling long forms.
Booking confirmation	Confirms the site visit and stores scheduled date, end time, duration, and status.	The customer has clarity and the business gains a reliable appointment record.
Google Calendar integration	Adds confirmed appointments to the configured Google Calendar.	The team can manage jobs from the calendar tools they already use.

Feature	What It Does	Client Benefit / Potential Gain
Reschedule detection	Detects when a customer asks to move the appointment and routes the conversation accordingly.	Schedule changes are handled without losing the lead.

4. Customer Email and Reminder System

Feature	What It Does	Client Benefit / Potential Gain
Email capture during booking	Asks for customer email and sends confirmation when available.	Creates a second communication channel beyond WhatsApp.
Booking confirmation email	Sends appointment details, service, area, and contact links.	Increases customer confidence and reduces confusion before the visit.
Customer reminders	Sends reminder emails and WhatsApp reminders before the appointment.	Reduces no-shows, late cancellations, and forgotten bookings.
Delayed-lead emails	Sends portfolio/pricing or follow-up email when a lead asks to delay.	Keeps longer-cycle projects alive instead of letting them disappear.
Inbound email processing	Customer email replies can be matched back to the appointment and notify the plumber.	The team stays aware of customer replies across channels.

5. Follow-Up and Lead Nurturing

Feature	What It Does	Client Benefit / Potential Gain
Automatic follow-up stages	Follows up leads across day 1, day 3, week 1, week 2, and month-style timing.	Prevents valuable leads from going cold due to silence.
Manual follow-up tools	Staff can send individual or bulk follow-ups from the dashboard.	Gives the team control when a personal push is needed.
Pause/resume auto-follow-up	Follow-ups can be disabled or re-enabled per lead.	Avoids over-messaging customers while keeping active leads organized.
Inactive/reactivated lead handling	Leads can be marked inactive or brought back into the pipeline.	Keeps reporting cleaner and focuses energy on live opportunities.
Delay signal follow-up	Detects customers who say they are not ready now and schedules later re-engagement.	Captures future revenue that would otherwise be forgotten.

6. Quotation and Document Workflow

Feature	What It Does	Client Benefit / Potential Gain
Create quotations from appointments	Turns captured appointment data into a quote.	Less retyping, faster quote turnaround.
Standalone quotations	Allows quotes without an existing appointment.	Supports walk-in, phone, or manually sourced opportunities.
PDF quotation generation	Builds professional quotation PDFs.	Improves perceived professionalism and makes pricing easy to share.
Send quotations via WhatsApp	Delivers the quotation directly to the customer.	Reduces friction between quote creation and customer receipt.
Quotation templates	Reusable templates with default items, labour, transport, and optional lines.	Faster quoting and more consistent pricing across jobs.

7. Site Visit, Job Scheduling, and Operations

Feature	What It Does	Client Benefit / Potential Gain
Site visit completion	Marks a site visit as complete and records notes and assessment.	Turns sales activity into actionable job planning.
Job appointment creation	Schedules the actual job after a completed site visit.	Creates a clear handover from assessment to paid work.
Plumber assignment	Assigns a plumber to the job appointment.	Improves accountability and preparation.
Job status tracking	Tracks pending schedule, scheduled, in progress, completed, and cancelled states.	The team can see where every job sits in the pipeline.
Job reminders	Sends job reminders to the customer and plumber before scheduled work.	Improves attendance, readiness, and customer confidence.

8. Media, Portfolio, Plans, and Trust Builders

Feature	What It Does	Client Benefit / Potential Gain
Customer plan/file upload	Receives plans, photos, documents, and videos from customers.	The plumber can assess scope before visiting or quoting.
Plan review status	Tracks pending upload, uploaded, reviewed, and ready to book.	Complex projects move through a clear process.
Previous work photos	Sends completed-work images or portfolio examples on request.	Builds trust and helps customers visualize the outcome.
Pricing overview responses	Handles common service and price questions in English or Shona.	Customers get enough pricing context to stay engaged.
Portfolio/pricing PDF by email	Can attach a portfolio and pricing guide to delayed leads.	Strengthens credibility and keeps future projects warm.

9. Management Dashboard and Reporting

Feature	What It Does	Client Benefit / Potential Gain
Main dashboard	Shows appointments, hot leads, and recent activity.	Management gets a quick operational snapshot.
Appointments list and detail pages	View, update, confirm, complete, cancel, and export appointments.	Centralizes daily customer management.
Priority leads dashboard	Surfaces hot and very hot leads with update controls.	Helps the team chase the opportunities most likely to pay.
Follow-up dashboard	Shows leads awaiting follow-up and manual follow-up actions.	Keeps pipeline discipline visible.
Calendar view	Visual appointment calendar.	Easier scheduling and workload planning.
User management and security pages	Login, profile, user management, security logs, and sessions.	Protects operational data and controls team access.

Complete Funnel Map

The funnel below maps the customer journey from first WhatsApp enquiry through booking, site visit, quotation, job completion, and the proposed Google review request.

Stage	Customer / Team Action	System Action	Business Gain
1. Customer enquiry	Customer sends WhatsApp message asking about plumbing service, price, availability, area, previous work, or a specific issue.	Plumbot captures the lead immediately and creates/updates the appointment record.	No enquiry is wasted.
2. Greeting and intent handling	Bot identifies whether the customer is asking a service question, price question, booking request, portfolio request, or needs clarification.	Customer receives a relevant reply in English, Shona, or mixed language.	Higher engagement and lower drop-off.
3. Value and trust building	Bot explains service value, handles common questions, shares pricing overview or previous work where appropriate.	Customer gains confidence before committing to a visit.	More prospects move from curiosity to booking intent.
4. Qualification	Bot collects project type, area, timeline, budget, property/house stage, plan status, and description.	Lead becomes operationally useful before a staff member gets involved.	Better site visit preparation and quote accuracy.
5. Lead scoring and priority alert	System recalculates score and classifies lead as cold, warm, hot, or very hot.	Very hot leads can trigger admin/plumber notification and bot pause for human takeover.	Faster response to the most valuable opportunities.
6. Availability selection	Bot offers or parses preferred appointment date/time while checking scheduling rules.	Customer chooses a workable slot.	Cleaner calendar, fewer back-and-forth messages.
7. Booking confirmation	Appointment is confirmed, Google Calendar event is created, WhatsApp confirmation is sent, and email is requested if missing.	Customer and team both have confirmed details.	Reduced no-shows and stronger professionalism.
8. Pre-visit reminders	Customer receives reminder messages/emails; plumber receives schedule briefings and upcoming job alerts.	Both sides are prepared before the visit.	Fewer wasted trips and better arrival readiness.
9. Site visit completion	Team marks the site visit completed and records notes, assessment, and next steps.	Sales context becomes a structured job record.	Less information loss between visit and quote.
10. Quotation	Team creates a quotation from appointment data or a reusable template, generates a PDF, and sends it via WhatsApp.	Customer receives a clear, professional price breakdown.	Faster quote turnaround and stronger close rate.
11. Job scheduling	Once accepted, the actual job is scheduled, assigned, and tracked separately from the original site visit.	Customer gets a clear work date and team knows the scope/materials.	Better operational planning and accountability.

Stage	Customer / Team Action	System Action	Business Gain
12. Job reminders and execution	Customer and plumber receive job reminders before work starts; job status moves through scheduled, in progress, and completed.	Work happens with fewer surprises.	More reliable job delivery and better customer satisfaction.
13. Job completion	Team marks the job as completed and stores completion notes.	The system knows the customer is now ready for aftercare.	Creates a trigger point for retention and reputation building.
14. New feature: Google review email	Immediately after completion, customer receives a polite email thanking them and asking for a Google review, with a direct review link.	Happy customers are guided to leave public proof while the positive experience is fresh.	More Google reviews, stronger local SEO, better trust, and more future bookings.
15. Post-completion reporting	Dashboard keeps completed appointment/job history, notes, quotes, and customer details.	Management can see what converted and where revenue came from.	Better decisions on sales, follow-up, staffing, and marketing.

New Google Review Feature Specification

The requested new feature should trigger when a job is marked completed. If the customer has an email address, Plumbot sends a short thank-you email with a direct Google review link. If no email is available, the dashboard can flag the customer for manual WhatsApp follow-up or prompt staff to add an email before completion.

Component	Recommended Behaviour	Client Benefit / Potential Gain
Trigger	When job_status or status changes to completed, or when job_completed_at is set.	Review request happens at the best moment: right after successful delivery.
Channel	Email first, because the user specifically requested email. Optional future WhatsApp fallback can be added.	Keeps aftercare professional and avoids crowding the WhatsApp sales conversation.
Message	Thank customer, mention the completed service, ask for a quick Google review, include direct review link, and keep the tone personal.	Higher review completion because the request is easy and timely.
Tracking	Add fields such as google_review_email_sent_at and google_review_requested to prevent duplicate requests.	Protects customer experience and keeps reporting reliable.
Dashboard signal	Show whether the review email was sent, skipped, or failed.	Staff can manually rescue missed review opportunities.
Business impact	More Google reviews improve local trust, search visibility, and conversion from future leads.	Potential gain: stronger reputation flywheel and lower dependency on paid lead sources.

Client-Facing Benefits to Emphasize

- More leads captured instantly through WhatsApp, including after-hours enquiries.
- Less manual admin because Plumbot qualifies customers before staff intervene.
- Better lead prioritization through hot and very hot scoring.
- Fewer missed appointments through reminders and calendar scheduling.
- Faster, more professional quotations through templates and PDFs.
- Better operational handover from site visit to scheduled job.
- More repeatable reputation growth through automated Google review requests after completed work.
- A clearer management view of leads, appointments, quotes, follow-ups, and jobs.

Suggested Implementation Note

To implement the Google review feature cleanly, add a customer email utility such as `send_google_review_request_email(appointment)`, add duplicate-prevention fields on the Appointment model, and call the email sender when the job is marked completed in the job status update flow. The Google review URL should be stored in settings or environment variables so it can be changed without code edits.